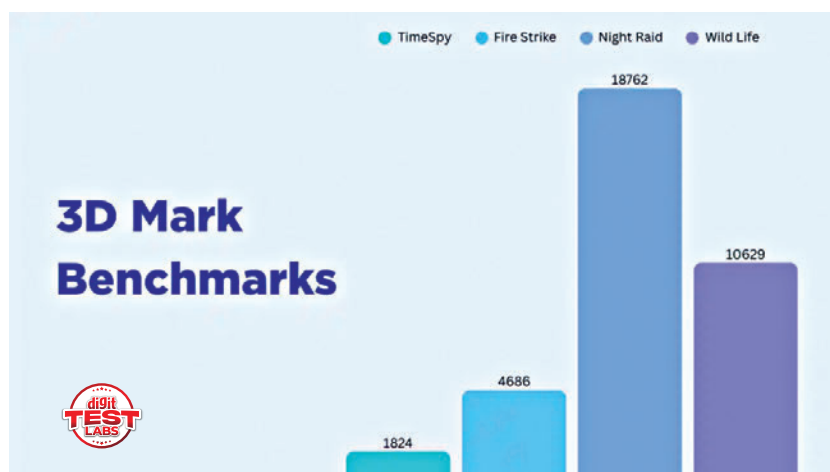




able, with keys that are well-spaced and satisfying tactile feedback. As someone who types for several hours every day, this matters to me quite a lot. The keys have a slight clicky sound, which I personally enjoy because it helps me stay focused while typing.

I usually use my M3 MacBook Air 15-inch as my daily driver and absolutely love its keyboard. But switching from that to the Zenbook 14 was also quite simple. Within a day, I was typing at full speed without having to look down. The keyboard is also backlit, which is perfect for late-night work sessions, and there is a dedicated Copilot key for quick access to AI features.

The touchpad is smooth, accurate, and generously sized. It registers gestures reliably and feels pleasant to use for long periods. One interesting feature is the built-in NumberPad that lights up on the touchpad when you press longer on the top right corner. This turned out to be more useful than I initially expected, especially when working with figures and symbols during editing and planning. The only challenge was remembering that the feature existed in the first place.

PERFORMANCE

Under the hood, the Asus Zenbook 14 is powered by the AMD Ryzen AI 5 430, paired with 16 GB of LPDDR5 RAM and a 1 TB SSD. In day to day usage, performance feels exactly as you would

expect from a premium productivity laptop. Apps open quickly, multitasking is smooth, and the system remains responsive even with multiple programs running simultaneously. I regularly ran Google Chrome with several tabs, Microsoft Word, Excel, File Manager, Edge, and Notepad all at once, without experiencing any slowdowns.

The benchmark testing results also reflected this performance. To test the CPU, I ran PC Mark, Geekbench and Cinebench on the laptop. And while the numbers aren't exactly ground-breaking, they are solid for a productivity laptop around the Rs 1 lakh mark.

In the PC Mark benchmark test, the laptop scored 6,111 points overall with 10,260 in Essentials, 11,925 in App Start-up and 9,464 in the Video Conferencing test. It also scored 9,223 points in productivity, 11,337 in spreadsheets and 7,504 in Writing.

In the Geekbench benchmark test, the single-core score stood at 2,372, while the multi-core score was 7,413. Coming to the Cinebench R23 benchmark test, the laptop scored 6,413 points in multi-core and 1,696 points in the single-core test. It also didn't lose much performance in the throttle test.

For graphics, I ran multiple 3D Mark benchmark tests, including Time Spy, Fire Strike, Night Raid, and Wild Life. And considering that the laptop relies solely on integrated graphics, the numbers are quite justified.

The storage performance was also quite excellent. The Crystal Disk Mark benchmark test showed super-fast read and write speeds, and in PC Mark's full system SSD test, the laptop scored a respectable 2,124 points.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

So, should you buy the Asus Zenbook 14? If you are looking for a lightweight office laptop that offers reliable performance, an excellent display, and outstanding battery life, the answer is yes. But do keep in mind that the laptop is not perfect. The hinge could be smoother, the speakers could be better, and an extra Type C port would have been a welcome addition. But as a work machine that quietly gets things done without drama, the Zenbook 14 delivers.

—Divyanshi Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: AMD Ryzen AI 5 430 | GPU: Integrated AMD Radeon | NPU: AMD XDNA NPU upto 50TOPS | RAM: 16 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 1 TB M.2 NVMe PCIe 4.0 | Display: 14-inch 3K OLED Touchscreen | Operating System: Windows 11 Home | Battery: 75 WHrs 4-cell Li-ion | Power supply: 68W AC Type-C | Refresh Rate: 60Hz | Camera: FHD camera with IR

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